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Speaker test

Sony	Tech-com	Zebronics
SRS-Z50	SSD-401 USB	ZEB-S2100
Rs. 4,200	Rs. 225	Rs. 550
33.26	26.53	36.02
3.75	3.75	3.75
29.51	22.78	32.27
NA	NA	6W
NA	NA	NA
NA	NA	NA
NA	NA	3W x 2
NA	100Hz - 18kHz	100Hz - 18kHz
NA	NA	NA
NA	NA	3-inch
Y	Y	Y
N	N	N
N	N	N
N	N	N
Y	Y	Y
N	N	N
N	N	N
Y	N	N
N	N	N
N	N	N
0	0	3
2	1.5	3
2.5	2	3.5
3	3	3
3.5	3.5	3.5
3.5	3	3.5
4	4	3.5
4	3	4.5
4	3	3.5
3	2	3.5
3.5	1.5	4
3	4	3
3	2.5	4
4	2	4
3	2	3.5
3.5	2	4
4.5	3	3.5
5	5	5
5	8	5
5	4	5

The vocals weren't very nice either as bass would mix up or be reproduced by the satellites once the volume was increased.

The F&D F6000 was also very good for music and movies. However, we heard some serious noise at the extreme low-end of the fre-

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Artis	Kunhar Peripherals Pvt. Ltd	+91-98201 36204	sales@kunhar.com	www.artis.co.in
Creative	Vinod Thakkar	+91-22-6451 0751	india_getcreative@ctl.creative.com	www.creative.com
F&D	Fenda Audio(India) Pvt. Ltd,	+91-11-4502 0119	customer@tveindia.com	www.fenda.com
Intex	Intex Technologies Ltd	1-800-11-6789	info@intextechnologies.com	www.intextechnologies.com
Logitech	Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd	+91-22-67090828	response@rptechindia.com	www.logitech.com
Philips	Philips Pvt. Ltd	1800-10-22929	customer@philips.com	www.consumer.philips.com
Sony	Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd	+91-22-67090828	response@rptechindia.com	www.sony.co.in
Tech-Com	Shree Sagarmatha Distributors Pvt Ltd	+91-11-2642 8541	dlh@techcomindia.com	www.techcomindia.com
Zebronics	Top Notch Infotronix India Pvt Ltd	+91-44-4393 6000	enquiry@zebronics.info	www.zebronics.net

quency spectrum (around 20Hz). It sounded like some of the speaker internals colliding with each other. Imagine a 10-inch driver trying to move 20 times a second; something's bound to go wrong. It almost feels like F&D went overboard with the woofer and totally forgot about the satellites.

The final verdict(s)

This year's speaker test has seen new comers and more competition in the market. It's almost always results in good products. Looking at 2.0 solutions, it was clear from the very beginning that the Audioengine A2 was a step ahead of the others. The A2 is one of the products at the base of their lineup and they cater to somewhat audiophile audience. Still, it's a deserving performer in the 2.0 category. The Best Buy award which is given to products that offer the best bang for the buck goes to the F&D V620. In comparison to the others, it might look small, but with its portability, it could be a good laptop companion. At Rs. 885, it's one of the cheapest speakers we received. The Zebronics ZEB-

S2100 is the next best VFM suggestion.

For a large room full of people, it's back to the Audioengine A2 – they're ridiculously loud for the size. The Creative Gigaworks HD50 is a great set as well but the price tag of Rs. 14,999 is a bit much.

If you're looking for value

output is better than the others by quite a bit.

Among all the surround sound speakers, the best value for money award goes to the Zebronics ZEB-SW7000R. At 2,750, it's easily affordable. At 80W, it's not exactly weak either. If you want over-the-top power, good audio quality, then there



2.1 speakers, you only have to spend Rs. 1,100, on the Zebronics ZEB-SW2600W. For that much, you get audio quality and performance that matches products priced at five to six times its price. If your budget isn't Rs. 1,100, and more like Rs.16,699, then the Creative T3 should be on your shopping list. Creative claims the speakers have Audiophile Grade Drivers and there seems to be some truth to the statement. The quality of all the components and sound

really is no recommendation other than the Logitech Z-5500.

There has been good development in the speaker market. We've now moved on to speakers that are not just powerful but more precise. It would be good to see more and more audiophile class manufacturers entering the desktop speaker market. If you haven't already bought a speaker set, and are itching to do so, it's a good time to do it – decent products at very economical prices. **d**